



Nima Dorostkar
Product Design & Full-Stack Engineering ·
Django/DRF · React

PROFORMA ·
PRELIMINARY

Project Proposal

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PREPARED FOR — CLIENT

Nima Shafiezadeh
Project Owner — Personal
Knowledge Platform

PREPARED BY — PERFORMER

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THE ENGAGEMENT

Design & development of a personal knowledge platform

A content-first system — **Personal Knowledge · Digital Garden · Personal Archive** — built as one content graph under three editorial policies, on Django + DRF, PostgreSQL, React, and Celery/Redis, containerized with Docker and deployed to a VPS. This preliminary proposal outlines two engagement paths — a lean **Economic** build first, and a complete **Professional** build — described by **scope and timeline**. Effort is shown in working days; commercial figures follow separately at contract stage.

1

OPTION 1 · RECOMMENDED START

Economic — Essentials

85 working days

PHASE / DELIVERABLE

EFFORT

— PRODUCT DESIGN

1 Analysis & Research

7 d

Focused requirements & core information architecture

PHASE / DELIVERABLE	EFFORT
2 Initial Design Key screens & flows, lightweight wireframes	10 d
3 Finalizing the Design Practical UI direction ready to build against	8 d
Design subtotal	25 d
 PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT	
1 Backend Development Models, business logic, Django/DRF APIs — the content graph & policy layer	20 d
2 Frontend Development UI implementation & state management for core screens	18 d
3 Integrations Essential third-party services, payments, webhooks	7 d
4 Code Review Standards & quality gates on delivered code	5 d
5 Bug Fixes & Support Post-delivery stabilization window	4 d
6 Deployment & Maintenance Docker + VPS/Nginx deploy and basic upkeep	6 d
Development subtotal	60 d
Lean, essentials-only — a fast path to a working product you can use daily.	≈ 17 weeks · 4 months

PHASE / DELIVERABLE

EFFORT

— PRODUCT DESIGN

1 Discovery & Research

6 d

User research (interviews, surveys, observation) · market/competitor analysis & positioning · personas · Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) · problem definition

2 Strategy & Definition

4 d

Product vision & goals (north star, success metrics) · value proposition · scope & prioritization (MoSCoW, RICE, roadmap) · user stories & requirements

3 Information Architecture

4 d

Content structure · user flows · sitemap / navigation model · task flows & journey maps

4 Interaction Design (UX)

8 d

Low-fidelity wireframes · clickable prototypes (Figma) · interaction patterns (states, transitions, micro-interactions) · usability testing & iteration

5 Visual Design (UI)

13 d

Design system (color, typography, spacing, tokens) · component library · high-fidelity mockups · responsive / mobile-first · accessibility (WCAG contrast, keyboard, screen readers)

6 Handoff & Validation

4 d

Design specs / handoff (tokens, measurements, assets for devs) · design QA vs. implementation · feedback loops (post-launch analytics, heatmaps, iteration)

Design subtotal

39 d

— PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT

PHASE / DELIVERABLE	EFFORT
1 Planning & Setup Technical requirements (specs → engineering tasks) · architecture decision (monolith vs microservices, stack selection) · tech stack (languages, frameworks, DB, infra) · environment setup (repos, branching, tooling) · task breakdown (epics → stories → tasks, estimation)	6 d
2 System Design Database design (schema, relationships/ERD, indexing) · API design (endpoints, contracts, request/response) · architecture (services, queues, caching, data flow) · security design (auth, authorization, data protection)	10 d
3 Implementation Backend (models, business logic, Django/DRF APIs) · frontend (UI, state management) · integrations (third-party services, payments, webhooks) · async/background jobs (Celery, queues, workers) · code review (standards, quality gates)	44 d
4 Testing / QA Unit tests · integration tests · API tests · end-to-end (full user scenarios) · performance/load testing · security testing (vulnerability scans)	14 d
5 Deployment Containerization (Docker) · CI/CD pipeline (build, test, deploy) · infrastructure (cloud/VPS, Nginx, DB setup) · release strategy (blue-green, canary, feature flags) · environment config (staging vs production, secrets management)	8 d
6 Operations & Maintenance Monitoring & logging (Prometheus, Grafana, error tracking) · bug fixes & support · performance optimization (profiling, scaling) · security patching & updates · iteration (new features from feedback & metrics) Initial engagement block; ongoing beyond launch via monthly retainer.	8 d
Development subtotal	90 d
Complete, durable build — full research, design system, testing, CI/CD and operations for the long term.	≈ 25–26 weeks · 6 months

THE TWO CASES, EXPLAINED BY TIMING

1 · Economic

≈ 17 weeks · 4 months (solo, ~5 days/week)

A lean path to a working product. It compresses design to the essentials and ships the core backend + frontend, key integrations, and a basic deploy — trading extensive test automation, a formal design system, and full ops tooling for speed. Ideal to validate the idea in real use first.

- Core content graph & three-policy backend (Django/DRF)
- Frontend for the primary screens
- Essential integrations + code review + short support window
- Docker + VPS deploy; lighter testing & ops

Best to launch fast, prove daily use, then grow into Option 2.

2 · Professional

≈ 25–26 weeks · 6 months (solo, ~5 days/week)

The complete, durable build. Time goes up front into discovery, UX research, a real design system, and formal system design, then through a full testing suite, CI/CD, monitoring, and an operations window — depth now for an extensible, low-maintenance platform for years, matching the project's "quality over speed, longevity is a feature" principles.

- Full discovery → strategy → IA → UX → UI design track
- Design system, component library & accessibility
- Formal DB / API / security design before coding
- Complete automated testing (unit → E2E, performance, security)
- CI/CD, release strategy, monitoring & observability

Best when this is the long-term home of your digital presence.

Both estimates assume a single practitioner working ~5 days/week with timely client feedback; elapsed calendar time may extend with review cycles. The scopes are additive — starting with Option 1 and later adding the remaining Professional deliverables reaches the same end state.

MILESTONES & TERMS

Payment model — per completed phase

Mobilization deposit — on signing, before work begins	20%
Each phase — invoiced on completion & acceptance	80%

Applies to **both options**. A 20% deposit starts the engagement; the remaining 80% is billed phase by phase as each phase is delivered and accepted, pro-rated by that phase's share of the total working days. No large lump sum at the end — you pay for progress as it lands.

Notes

- Due to the constant change in Iranian prices, all figures are quoted in **US dollars (USD)**.
- This is a **preliminary proposal** — scope & timeline only; commercial terms follow at contract stage.
- Estimates are **day-based**; scope changes are re-scoped before work begins.
- Third-party costs (VPS, domain, licenses, paid APIs) are **out of scope** and arranged by the client.
- Maintenance beyond the included window: optional **monthly retainer**.
- Source code, designs & content **belong to the client** on completion.
- **Two review rounds** included per major deliverable.